MERCY'S ANATOMY

Season 2, Episode 19

"Deserve"

Episode 2x19. The counterpart of *Grey's Anatomy* 2x19. Narrator: Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock

In-story dates: Monday, February 27, 2006 (Lundi Gras), 6:08 AM through 11:58 PM

Script: Cold Open + 5 Acts + Tag. 41 scenes. Standard: MA-009

Depends on MA-001 through MA-011 and episodes 1x01-2x18

EPISODE PDF PACKAGE (MA-009 §6): 1. Title page and cast (with ages on Monday, February 27, 2006). 2. Script. 3. Media Companion. 4. Continuity Sheet.

Cast in Order of Appearance (Ages on Monday, February 27, 2006)

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock	Surgical Intern (narrator)	Jan 5, 1979	27
Dr. Raven Ellison	Surgical Intern	Dec 3, 1979	26
Dr. Harmony Divine	Surgical Intern	Jun 19, 1979	26
Dr. Faith Danforth (debut)	Veterinarian, Astoria Animal Hospital	Nov 2, 1972	33
Dr. Esther Smilley	Surgical Intern	Sep 20, 1979	26
Dr. Amond Baker	Surgical Intern	Feb 10, 1979	27
Dr. Arianna Cummings	Surgical Intern	Oct 25, 1979	26
Dr. Nnamdi Okoye	Surgical Resident (PGY-4)	Oct 1, 1974	31
Dr. Elxa Bullock	Surgical Resident (on maternity leave)	Aug 29, 1977	28
Quinton Rhames (new)	Patient: GSWs to the liver; homicide suspect	Jun 30, 1981	24
Dr. Abraham Lowery	Attending General Surgeon	Jan 9, 1947	59
Nurse Gloria Pettiford	Head ER Nurse	Apr 14, 1952	53
Darius 'Dash' Duvall	Patient: LVAD driveline infection (readmitted)	Aug 8, 1971	34
Glenda Duvall	Dash's mother	Dec 12, 1947	58
Dr. Robert Bullock	Chief of Cardiothoracic Surgery (50 since February 10)	Feb 10, 1956	50
Dr. Clayton Hartwell	OB/GYN and Fetal Surgeon (patient, discreetly)	Mar 3, 1971	34
Dr. Natasha Donohue	Chief of Surgery	Jun 2, 1958	47
Bernadette 'Bernie' Watkins	Executive Assistant to the Chief	Jun 6, 1950	55
Sister Khadijah Bey (new)	Widow of Abdul-Rahman Bey	Sep 1, 1947	58
Yusuf Bey (new)	Khadijah's son; Con Ed worker	Dec 20, 1975	30
Dr. Bryce Kennerly	Surgical Intern	Jun 11, 1978	27
Lamont 'Monty' Gaines	Owner, Monty's on Jackson	Oct 10, 1962	43
Nurse Kendra Wallace	Surgical Floor Nurse	May 30, 1980	25
Dr. Malcolm Sloan	Chief of Plastic Surgery	Feb 14, 1968	38
Dr. Camille Toussaint	Orthopedic Resident	Jul 21, 1976	29
Russell Jeffries	Elxa's husband	Apr 3, 1975	30
Dr. Leland Graves	Chief of Neurosurgery	Apr 18, 1953	52
Dorothea Rhames (new)	Quinton's mother; home-care aide	Aug 8, 1961	44
Dr. Harold Bynum	Consult-Liaison Psychiatrist	Oct 19, 1942	63

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Dr. Paulette Greenidge	Couples therapist, Montague Street	Aug 1, 1955	50
Russell Harmon 'Tuck' Jeffries Jr.	Elxa's son (3 weeks)	Feb 5, 2006	0
Mercy	The House's pit bull puppy (5 months)	Sep 30, 2005	0

Also appearing: paramedics, two NYPD officers, a homicide detective, an anesthesiologist, ICU nurses, a teenager with a wrist fracture, and a rescued kitten. Mentioned: Abdul-Rahman Bey (killed at 7:10 AM), Augustin Toussaint, Raymond Cummings, Kat Smilley and a Ditmars Labrador with a cake habit.

COLD OPEN

1 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - PRE-DAWN
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 6:08 AM

The kitchen. On the floor, a torn-open red satin heart-shaped box, empty except for crumpled paper cups. A card nearby, chewed at one corner: "To my Valentine. Sorry it's late. They don't let you buy candy in the CVICU. -D." Mercy, five months old and lanky, stands in the middle of the floor, panting, trembling, her one ear up. She vomits on the tile.

Marc (27) runs in in his boxers and a T-shirt. Raven (26) is right behind him in her bonnet.

RAVEN
(horrified)
Oh, no. (beat) Oh, no, no. (beat) Those were from Dash. (beat) I left them on the counter.

MARC
(dropping to his knees beside the dog)
How many?

RAVEN
(beat, counting the cups)
Twelve. (beat) Dark chocolate. (beat) Godiva. (beat) The whole box.

Harmony (26) skids into the doorway.

HARMONY
(instantly)
Theobromine. (beat) Dogs can't metabolize it. (beat) Dark chocolate's the worst. (beat) Vomiting, tremors, racing heart, then seizures. (beat) My cousin's beagle ate a pan of brownies in 1996.

MARC
(feeling Mercy's chest)
Heart rate's flying. (beat) She's shaking.

MARC (V.O.)
They teach you that every patient deserves the same care.

He scoops the dog up in his arms like a child.

MARC
(beat)
Where's the nearest emergency vet?

RAVEN
(beat, already grabbing the phone book)
There's one in Astoria. (beat) On Thirty-first Street. (beat) It opens at seven.

MARC
(beat, already at the door with Mercy wrapped in a towel)
It's going to open at six-thirty.

2 EXT. ASTORIA ANIMAL HOSPITAL - 31ST STREET, ASTORIA - DAWN
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 6:31 AM

Gray dawn. Snow melting in gray piles along the curb under the elevated N train tracks. A narrow storefront with a hand-painted sign: "ASTORIA ANIMAL HOSPITAL. EST. 1962." The windows are dark. A red Vespa is chained to a pole out front. Marc, in sweatpants and a coat thrown over his T-shirt, bangs on the door with one fist, Mercy wrapped in a towel in his other arm.

MARC
(shouting)
Hello! (beat) Hello! (beat)
Please!

A light comes on in the window upstairs. A minute later, the door opens. DR. FAITH DANFORTH (33), barefoot, in flannel pajama pants and a sweatshirt that says "UCONN VETERINARY," her hair in a messy knot, a mug of coffee in her hand. She takes one look at the shaking dog.

FAITH
(calm, instantly awake)
What did she eat?

MARC
(beat)
Twelve dark chocolate truffles. (beat) Godiva. (beat) About forty minutes ago. (beat) She's about thirty pounds. (beat) She's vomited once. (beat) Heart rate's way up. (beat) Tremors.

Faith sets down her coffee on the windowsill, steps aside and holds the door open.

FAITH
(beat)
Bring her in. (beat) You're very precise for a man in sweatpants.

MARC (V.O.)
What they don't teach you is what to do when somebody you love is on the table and you can't be the one holding the knife.

MARC
(beat, carrying Mercy in)
I'm a surgeon.

FAITH
(beat, flipping on the lights)
Then you're going to hate this part. (beat) You get to stand there.

END OF COLD OPEN

ACT ONE

3 INT. ASTORIA ANIMAL HOSPITAL - EXAM ROOM - DAWN
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 6:44 AM

A small, worn, spotless exam room. A steel table. Posters about heartworm. Mercy lies on the table, trembling, while Faith listens to her heart with a stethoscope. Marc stands against the wall, his hands balled in his coat pockets.

FAITH
(listening)
One-ninety. (beat) Sinus tachycardia. (beat) No arrhythmia. (beat) Good. (beat) Forty minutes is still in the window.

She draws up a syringe and injects a small dose into the dog's vein in one smooth motion.

FAITH
(beat)
Apomorphine. (beat) She's going to throw up everything in her stomach in about two minutes. (beat) Then activated charcoal so she doesn't absorb what's left. (beat) IV fluids to flush her kidneys. (beat) And I'll watch her heart all morning.

MARC
(beat)
Is she going to be okay?

FAITH
(beat, gently, stroking the dog's lopsided ear)
Twelve truffles for a thirty-pound puppy is a lot, but it's not the worst I've seen. (beat) A Lab ate a whole birthday cake with a pound of dark chocolate frosting on Ditmars in December. (beat) He's fine. (beat) He still steals cake.

Mercy retches. Faith holds her head over a basin, steady, patient. The chocolate comes up. Faith checks it with a gloved finger and nods, satisfied.

FAITH
(beat, looking at Marc for the first time)
What's her name?

MARC
(beat)
Mercy.

FAITH
(beat, a small smile)
That's a good name for a dog who just had a near-death experience with Godiva.

4 INT. ASTORIA ANIMAL HOSPITAL - EXAM ROOM - MORNING
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 7:06 AM

Mercy, groggy now, lies on a blanket on the table with an IV in her foreleg, her tail thumping weakly whenever Marc touches her. Faith has pulled a cardigan over her sweatshirt and finally put on shoes. She writes on a chart. She glances up at Marc, then at the faint pink scar over his left eyebrow.

FAITH
(beat)
You can go to work. (beat) I'll keep her until five. (beat) If anything changes, I'll call you.

MARC
(beat)
I can stay.

FAITH
(beat)
You're a surgeon at Queens Grace, Dr...?

MARC
(beat)
Bullock. (beat) Marc.

Faith pauses. She looks at the scar again. Then at his hands. She recognizes him, the way half of Queens would. But she doesn't say it.

FAITH
(beat, gently)
Dr. Bullock. (beat) I'm Faith Danforth. (beat) Your dog is going to be fine. (beat) You can't do anything for her by standing against my wall for nine hours. (beat) Go to work. (beat) Come back at five. (beat) She'll be waiting.

MARC
(beat)
You knew who I was.

FAITH
(beat, writing)
I knew who you were when you said "sinus tachycardia" at six-thirty in the morning in sweatpants. (beat) Everything else is the Daily News. (beat) I don't read the Daily News, Dr. Bullock. (beat) I read the vet journals and the comics.

Marc almost smiles.

MARC
(beat)
Thank you. (beat) For opening the door.

FAITH
(beat, not looking up)
I live upstairs. (beat) When a man bangs on my door at six-thirty holding a dog in a towel, I always open it. (beat) That's the whole job.

5 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - INTERNS' LOCKER ROOM - MORNING
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 7:28 AM

Marc comes in late, changing fast. Harmony and Raven are still at their lockers. Esther (26) sits on the bench lacing her shoes. Amond (27) and Arianna (26) are at the far end.

RAVEN
(anxious)
Is she okay? (beat) Mercy?

MARC
(pulling on his scrub top)
She's okay. (beat) Apomorphine, charcoal, IV fluids. (beat) The vet opened at six-thirty in her pajamas. (beat) Dr. Danforth. (beat) Thirty-first Street, under the N. (beat) She rides a Vespa.

HARMONY
(beat, knowing)
She rides a Vespa.

MARC
(beat)
It was parked out front.

HARMONY
(beat, grinning)
And you noticed the Vespa.

At the end of the bench, Esther ties her second shoe very slowly.

ESTHER
(beat, not looking up, too casual)
What's she like? (beat) The vet.

MARC
(beat)
Kind. (beat) Calm. (beat) She held Mercy's head while she threw up chocolate and told me a story about a Lab and a birthday cake.

ESTHER
(beat, standing)
That's nice.

She closes her locker a little harder than she needs to and walks out. Harmony and Raven exchange a look. Amond, at the far end, doesn't look up from his journal.

AMOND
(dry)
That was jealousy, Marc. (beat)
In case you need it labeled.

6 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL FLOOR - NURSES' STATION - MORNING
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 7:37 AM

Dr. Okoye (31) runs the board. The interns gather. Beside the station, in jeans and a wool coat, a baby carrier on her arm with a three-week-old Tuck asleep inside, stands Elxa (28). She's visiting. She looks like she hasn't slept in three weeks, because she hasn't.

OKOYE
(beat)
Dr. Bullock is not here. (beat)
Dr. Bullock is on maternity leave. (beat) Dr. Bullock is visiting her husband in Neuro step-down and stopped by to "look at the board."

ELXA
(beat)
It's a terrible board, Okoye. (beat) You've got Kennerly in the ER again.

OKOYE
(beat)
Kennerly's good in the ER.

ELXA
(beat, conceding)
Kennerly is good in the ER.

OKOYE
(reading off)
Bullock: Lowery, the ER, a GSW coming in from Corona with police. (beat) Ellison: CVICU. Your LVAD patient's back. (beat) Fever. (beat) Baker: Cardio. (beat) Divine: Ortho. (beat) Smilley: Neuro. (beat) Cummings: Lowery, with Bullock. (beat) Kennerly: ER.

Raven freezes at "your LVAD patient's back." She's already moving before Okoye finishes.

ELXA
(beat, watching Raven go, to Okoye)
She's going to get her heart broken.

OKOYE
(beat)
Page four of your instructions. (beat) "Ellison loves too hard. Don't try to stop her. Just stand close."

7 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - TRAUMA 1 - MORNING
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 7:52 AM

Paramedics rush in a gurney. On it, a young man, QUINTON RHAMES (24), in a bloodstained hoodie, handcuffed to the rail, gasping, two gunshot wounds in his right upper abdomen. Two uniformed NYPD officers walk on either side, grim. Lowery (59), Marc, Arianna and Gloria meet them.

PARAMEDIC
(fast)
Twenty-four-year-old male. (beat) Two GSWs, right upper quadrant. (beat) Police-involved. (beat) Pressure eighty over fifty. (beat) Heart rate one forty.

OFFICER ONE
(flat)
He shot a store owner on Roosevelt Avenue in Corona at seven-ten. (beat) During a robbery. (beat) The owner's dead. (beat) Our guys shot him running out.

A beat. Marc, Arianna and Gloria all hear it. Lowery doesn't look up from the patient.

LOWERY
(calm)
On my count. (beat) One, two, three.

They move him to the trauma bed. Gloria cuts away the hoodie. Marc puts in a second IV. His hands are steady, but his jaw is tight.

MARC
(beat)
Two entry wounds, right upper quadrant. (beat) One exit, right flank. (beat) FAST is positive. (beat) Blood in Morison's pouch.

LOWERY
(beat)
Liver. (beat) OR, now. (beat) Type and cross six. (beat) Uncuff him.

OFFICER TWO
(beat)
Doctor, he's a homicide suspect.

LOWERY
(beat, finally looking up)
He's a patient with a hole in his liver, Officer. (beat) You can stand outside the OR door with your hand on your gun. (beat) But I'm not operating around a handcuff.

The officer looks at his partner. His partner nods. He unlocks the cuff. Quinton, half conscious, looks up at Marc.

QUINTON
(barely)
Am I gonna die?

Marc looks down at him. At the young face. At the blood. He thinks of Sergeant Burrell's body under a flag.

MARC
(beat, evenly)
Not if we're fast.

8 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CVICU - BED 3 - MORNING
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 8:09 AM

Dash (34), back in the CVICU, flushed and shivering under the Panthers blanket. A HeartMate controller sits on his tray table with its battery pack, a cable running under his gown to his abdomen. The pump hums. His mother Glenda (58) holds his hand. Robert (50) examines the driveline exit site on Dash's belly: red, swollen, oozing yellow. Raven arrives, breathless.

DASH
(weak, trying to grin)
Hey, Valentine. (beat) Did you get the chocolates?

RAVEN
(beat)
My dog ate them.

DASH
(beat, laughing, then shivering)
Is the dog okay?

RAVEN
(beat)
The dog is fine. (beat) You have a fever of a hundred and two point eight.

ROBERT
(beat)
Driveline infection. (beat) The exit site's purulent. (beat) Cultures, blood and wound. (beat) Vancomycin and cefepime. (beat) Ultrasound to make sure it hasn't tracked to the pump pocket.

GLENDA
(beat, frightened)
He was home three days. (beat) Three days, at my sublet on Twenty-first Street. (beat) He was walking. (beat) He went to the Steinway Street sneaker stores. (beat) He was so happy.

ROBERT
(beat, gently)
Mrs. Duvall, driveline infections are the most common complication of this pump. (beat) It's not anything he did. (beat) It's a cable through the skin. (beat) Skin doesn't like cables.

DASH
(beat, looking at Raven)
Does this mean I'm off the list?

RAVEN
(beat, quietly, checking with Robert)
No. (beat) A device complication keeps you at 1A. (beat) If anything, it moves you up.

DASH
(beat, closing his eyes)
Then I'll take the fever.

9 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LABOR AND DELIVERY - CLAYTON'S OFFICE - MORNING
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 8:31 AM

Clayton (34) stands behind his desk. He is not sitting. He has clearly been not sitting for some time. A ring-shaped inflatable cushion lies on his chair. Elxa, with Tuck's carrier on her arm, comes to the door because he paged her.

ELXA
(beat)
You paged me. (beat) I'm on maternity leave, Hartwell.

CLAYTON
(beat, low, closing the door behind her)
I know. (beat) I know you are. (beat) That's why I paged you.

ELXA
(beat, eyeing the cushion)
Why do you have a donut on your chair?

Clayton closes his eyes.

CLAYTON
(beat, with tremendous dignity)
I have a perianal abscess.

ELXA
(beat)
You have a what?

CLAYTON
(beat)
Five days. (beat) It's the size of a golf ball. (beat) I can't sit. (beat) I did a twin-twin transfusion laser yesterday standing on one leg. (beat) I need it drained.

ELXA
(beat, setting down the carrier)
Go to the ER.

CLAYTON
(beat, horrified)
The ER is staffed by interns I supervise. (beat) Smilley is my wife. (beat) Sloan is... (beat) Sloan. (beat) Lowery would never let me hear the end of it. (beat) Kennerly would put it on the blog. (beat) You are a third-year surgical resident who is on leave and has no reason to tell anybody anything.

ELXA
(beat, slowly beginning to smile)
You want me to drain your butt.

CLAYTON
(beat)
I want you to drain my perianal abscess, Dr. Bullock. (beat) In a procedure room. (beat) With the door locked. (beat) Discreetly.

ELXA
(beat, picking up Tuck's carrier)
Hartwell, you called my mother on Thanksgiving when I told you not to. (beat) Then you saved my son's life in a lockdown. (beat) I'll drain your butt. (beat) But I'm bringing the baby.

10 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CHIEF'S OFFICE - MORNING
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 8:52 AM

Natasha (47) at her desk. On the sofa: a folded blanket and a pillow. Two weeks since the confession, and some nights it's easier to sleep in her office than on Riverside Drive. Bernie (55) brings in the mail and the day's schedule.

NATASHA
(beat, not looking up)
Bernie. (beat) I need an appointment. (beat) Tonight, if possible. (beat) A couples therapist. (beat) Dr. Paulette Greenidge. (beat) Montague Street. (beat) Brooklyn Heights.

Bernie stops in the doorway.

BERNIE
(beat, carefully)
Dr. Paulette Greenidge.

NATASHA
(beat)
Is there a problem?

BERNIE
(beat)
No, ma'am. (beat) It's just that... (beat) I've heard she's very good. (beat) From certain people in this building.

NATASHA
(beat, finally looking up)
Dr. Smilley and Dr. Hartwell see her. (beat) Thursdays. (beat) I know. (beat) I'm the Chief of Surgery, Bernie. (beat) I read everybody's insurance forms. (beat) If she's good enough for two of my doctors, she's good enough for two of my department chiefs. (beat) Just make sure it's not a Thursday.

BERNIE
(beat, softly)
Yes, Dr. Donohue. (beat) And Dr. Donohue? (beat) St. Mary's at three. (beat) If you need it.

NATASHA
(beat)
I'll be there.

11 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 4 - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 9:14 AM

Quinton on the table, his abdomen open. Blood everywhere. Lowery has both hands inside, compressing the liver. Marc holds the retractor. Arianna suctions. The anesthesiologist hangs blood. Outside the OR window, a uniformed officer watches through the glass, his hand resting on his holster.

LOWERY
(calm)
Pringle. (beat) Dr. Bullock, clamp the portal triad.

Marc slides a vascular clamp across the hepatoduodenal ligament and closes it. The bleeding from the liver slows. Doesn't stop.

MARC
(beat)
It's still bleeding.

LOWERY
(beat)
Then it's coming from behind. (beat) The retrohepatic cava. (beat) Or a hepatic vein. (beat) Dr. Cummings, packs. (beat) Lots of packs.

The anesthesiologist looks up.

ANESTHESIOLOGIST
(beat)
Pressure's sixty. (beat) He's had eight units.

A beat. Lowery looks across the table at Marc. Marc's hands are steady on the clamp. But his face is hard.

LOWERY
(beat, quietly)
Dr. Bullock. (beat) Say it.

MARC
(beat)
Say what?

LOWERY
(beat)
Whatever you're thinking. (beat) Say it out loud now, so it doesn't end up in your hands.

MARC
(beat, barely)
A store owner is dead on Roosevelt Avenue. (beat) His family's going to bury him. (beat) And I'm holding this man's liver together.

LOWERY
(beat)
Yes. (beat) You are. (beat) That's the job. (beat) We don't operate on what he did, son. (beat) We operate on what's bleeding.

ANESTHESIOLOGIST
(beat)
Fifty-four. (beat) Abraham, he's going to arrest.

END OF ACT ONE

ACT TWO

12 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 4 - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 9:17 AM

The monitor alarms. The anesthesiologist pushes epinephrine. Lowery packs laparotomy sponges around the back of the liver with both hands, pressing them against the bleeding cava. Marc holds the Pringle clamp with one hand and presses packs with the other. Arianna suctions.

LOWERY
(calm, slow)
Pack it tight. (beat) Above and below. (beat) Push the liver back up against the diaphragm. (beat) Dr. Bullock, both hands. (beat) Lean on it.

Marc leans with his whole weight. The way he leaned on the aorta in January. The way he held the shell. Absolutely still.

ANESTHESIOLOGIST
(beat)
Sixty-two. (beat) Seventy. (beat) He's responding.

LOWERY
(beat)
Damage control. (beat) We leave the packs. (beat) Temporary closure. (beat) ICU. (beat) Warm him. (beat) Correct his clotting. (beat) We come back in forty-eight hours and take them out.

Lowery looks across the table at Marc.

LOWERY
(beat, quietly)
You held it, Dr. Bullock.

MARC
(beat, not moving)
I held it.

LOWERY
(beat)
How do you feel?

MARC
(beat, honestly)
Like I want to wash my hands for an hour.

13 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - FAMILY ROOM - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 9:41 AM

A small windowless room. A woman in her late fifties in a long black abaya and a gray hijab sits very straight on the sofa, her hands folded in her lap, her face set like stone: SISTER KHADIJAH BEY (58). Beside her, a young man of thirty in a Con Ed jacket, red-eyed: her son, YUSUF BEY (30). Kennerly stands at the door with a clipboard. A police detective stands by the wall.

DETECTIVE
(gently)
Mrs. Bey. (beat) I'm so sorry for your loss. (beat) Your husband died at the scene. (beat) The man who shot him is in surgery here.

KHADIJAH
(beat, very quietly)
Here. (beat) In this building.

DETECTIVE
(beat)
Yes, ma'am.

YUSUF
(standing, furious)
You're saving him? (beat) He walked into my father's store with a gun for a hundred and eighty dollars and two cartons of Newports, and you're saving him?

KENNERLY
(beat, steady)
Mr. Bey. (beat) The doctors don't get to choose. (beat) Nobody here chose this.

YUSUF
(beat)
I didn't choose it either!

Khadijah puts her hand on her son's arm. He sits down slowly.

KHADIJAH
(beat, to Kennerly, her voice never rising)
Abdul-Rahman ran that store on Roosevelt Avenue for thirty-one years. (beat) He gave credit to every mother on that block. (beat) He put the boys who stole candy to work sweeping instead of calling the police. (beat) Doctor, how old is the man who killed my husband?

KENNERLY
(beat, after a glance at the detective)
Twenty-four, ma'am.

KHADIJAH
(beat, closing her eyes)
Twenty-four. (beat) My husband's age when he opened the store.

14 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - PROCEDURE ROOM 2 - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 10:02 AM

A small locked procedure room. Clayton lies on his side on the table, facing the wall, in a hospital gown, his scrub pants folded on a chair. Elxa, gowned and gloved, sits on a stool behind him with a procedure tray. Tuck sleeps in his carrier on the counter in the corner. Elxa injects the local.

CLAYTON
(wincing, through his teeth)
You could have warned me.

ELXA
(beat)
I said, "Little pinch."

CLAYTON
(beat)
That was not a little pinch.

ELXA
(beat)
It's a little pinch compared to pushing a seven-pound boy out in a stairwell. (beat) Hold still, Hartwell. (beat) Scalpel.

She incises. Clayton makes a sound that no fetal surgeon has ever made in front of a colleague. Tuck stirs in the carrier and starts to whimper.

ELXA
(beat, irrigating, unbothered)
See? (beat) You woke the baby.

CLAYTON
(beat, muffled against the pillow)
I'm going to die on this table.

ELXA
(beat, packing the wound)
You're going to have a sitz bath twice a day and a little gauze packing for a week. (beat) And you're going to tell Dr. Smilley why you're walking funny.

CLAYTON
(beat)
No.

ELXA
(beat)
No more Octobers, Hartwell. (beat) Smilley told me. (beat) In the stairwell. (beat) It's a good rule. (beat) Tell your wife about your butt.

A long pause. Clayton stares at the wall.

CLAYTON
(beat, quietly)
Malcolm asked me to lunch. (beat) Yesterday. (beat) He left a note in my box. (beat) "Lunch. Monty's. Any day. You pick." (beat) I haven't told her that either.

ELXA
(beat, pulling off her gloves)
Then you've got two things to tell her. (beat) Start with the butt. (beat) It's the easier one.

15 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CVICU - BED 3 - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 10:27 AM

Dash, shivering less now, the vancomycin dripping. Glenda has gone for coffee. Raven sits on the edge of the bed checking his temperature: one hundred and one point six.

DASH
(beat)
Coming down.

RAVEN
(beat)
Coming down.

DASH
(beat, studying her)
Three days I was home, Raven. (beat) Mama's sublet on Twenty-first Street. (beat) I walked to Steinway Street and back. (beat) I bought a slice of pizza and ate it on a bench in the cold. (beat) I went into a sneaker store and didn't buy anything, just to see what they had. (beat) It was the best three days of my life.

RAVEN
(beat)
You called me every night.

DASH
(beat)
You picked up every night.

A silence.

DASH
(beat)
I've been thinking about something you said. (beat) In January. (beat) "I'm with somebody." (beat) Are you still?

Raven looks at the pump controller humming on the tray.

RAVEN
(beat, honestly)
She came to dinner two weeks ago. (beat) First time since January. (beat) She sat in the gallery during your pump surgery. (beat) For me. (beat) She said, "Not for him, for you." (beat) I don't know what we are, Dash. (beat) We're something. (beat) We're not over.

DASH
(beat, nodding slowly)
Okay. (beat) Thank you for not lying. (beat) That's all I need. (beat) Just no lying.

16 INT. MONTY'S ON JACKSON - BAR - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 11:12 AM

A slow late morning. Monty (43) restocks the bar. Kennerly (27) sits on a stool with a coffee, staring at his phone. Kendra Wallace (25) comes in from the cold on her break and orders a hot chocolate. Kennerly sees her. He puts the phone down. He picks it up. He puts it down again.

MONTY
(to nobody in particular)
Just ask her, Doctor. (beat) I've watched you do that with the phone four times.

Kendra turns. Kennerly glares at Monty.

KENDRA
(beat)
Ask me what?

KENNERLY
(beat, clearing his throat)
Dinner. (beat) Friday. (beat) Not here. (beat) Somewhere with tablecloths. (beat) If you want. (beat) You don't have to. (beat) I used you in September. (beat) You have every right to say no.

Kendra sips her hot chocolate and studies him for a long moment.

KENDRA
(beat)
You emptied eleven Foleys during the strike. (beat) Gloria told me. (beat) You didn't complain once. (beat) You asked her how to do it right.

KENNERLY
(beat)
Twelve. (beat) I emptied twelve. (beat) I didn't count the last one.

KENDRA
(beat, setting down the cup)
Friday. (beat) Tablecloths. (beat) You're paying.

17 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL ICU - CORRIDOR - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 11:39 AM

Marc comes out of the SICU, where Quinton lies packed and intubated under police guard. Esther comes up the corridor with a chart. She stops beside him.

ESTHER
(beat)
The GSW from Corona. (beat) The shooter.

MARC
(beat)
Packed liver. (beat) Damage control. (beat) He'll live, probably. (beat) The store owner won't.

ESTHER
(beat)
Are you okay?

MARC
(beat)
I'm fine.

A beat. Esther waits.

ESTHER
(beat, carefully, too casually)
How's Mercy?

MARC
(beat)
She's fine. (beat) Dr. Danforth called at eleven. (beat) Her heart rate's down to a hundred and ten. (beat) I can pick her up at five.

ESTHER
(beat)
Dr. Danforth.

MARC
(beat)
Faith. (beat) Her name's Faith.

A beat.

ESTHER
(beat)
Faith. (beat) That's a nice name. (beat) Very... (beat) hopeful.

MARC
(beat, looking at her)
Esther.

ESTHER
(beat, already walking away)
I'm late for Graves.

Marc watches her go. Down the hall, Malcolm stands at the elevators. He's seen the whole exchange. He looks at Marc. Then he looks at Esther walking away. Then he presses the elevator button and gets in.

18 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL ICU - BED 2 - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 12:03 PM

Quinton, intubated, sedated, his abdomen covered with a temporary plastic closure over the packs. A uniformed officer sits in the chair by the door. The sedation has been lightened for a neuro check. Marc and Arianna check his vitals. Quinton's eyes open. They find Marc.

Marc leans down to check his pupils. Quinton tries to talk around the tube. He can't. He lifts a weak hand and makes a writing motion. Arianna hands him a clipboard and a pen. He writes, slowly, in a scrawl.

He turns the clipboard around. Marc reads it.

"IS HE DEAD"

Marc looks at the young man for a long time.

MARC
(beat, evenly)
Yes. (beat) Mr. Bey died at the scene.

Quinton stares at him. Then he takes back the clipboard and writes again, slower, his hand shaking.

"I DIDNT MEAN TO. GUN WENT OFF."

Marc reads it. He hands the clipboard back to the officer by the door without a word. The officer reads it, takes out his notebook and writes something down.

OFFICER
(beat, quietly)
Thank you, Doctor.

Marc walks out of the room. Arianna follows him.

END OF ACT TWO

ACT THREE

19 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - STAIRWELL B - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 12:09 PM

Marc on the landing, both hands pressed flat against the cold concrete wall, breathing hard. Arianna stands a few steps below him.

ARIANNA
(beat)
You gave the officer the clipboard.

MARC
(beat, not turning)
It was evidence.

ARIANNA
(beat)
You didn't have to. (beat) Doctor-patient. (beat) You could have kept it.

MARC
(beat)
A man is dead, Arianna. (beat) His wife is downstairs in a hijab, sitting on a sofa. (beat) I held his killer's liver together with my bare hands for twenty minutes. (beat) The least I can do is not hide what he wrote.

ARIANNA
(beat)
Is that why your hands are shaking?

Marc looks at his hands. They are.

MARC
(beat, barely)
Last time a police officer said "thank you, Doctor," he was carrying a sergeant out of this building under a flag. (beat) I just... (beat) I heard the words and I was back on the loading dock.

Arianna comes up the last few steps and sits on the stairs beside him. She doesn't touch him.

ARIANNA
(beat)
My father shot a man once. (beat) In 1996. (beat) In Pittsburgh. (beat) Over forty dollars of heroin. (beat) The man lived. (beat) My father did six years at Western Penitentiary. (beat) The man's daughter was in my class at Schenley High School. (beat) She never spoke to me again.

MARC
(beat)
I didn't know that.

ARIANNA
(beat)
Nobody knows that. (beat) I'm telling you because it's the same thing. (beat) Somebody's always somebody's kid, Bullock. (beat) The shooter and the man he shot. (beat) Both.

20 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CHIEF'S OFFICE - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 12:34 PM

Natasha at her desk. Sister Khadijah Bey sits across from her, Yusuf standing behind her chair. Kennerly stands by the door.

KHADIJAH
(beat, very calmly)
Dr. Donohue. (beat) I would like to see him.

NATASHA
(beat, carefully)
Mrs. Bey, the man in our ICU is a homicide suspect in police custody. (beat) He's intubated. (beat) He can't speak. (beat) I can't...

KHADIJAH
(beat)
I don't need him to speak. (beat) I need him to see me.

Natasha studies the widow for a long moment.

NATASHA
(beat)
Why?

KHADIJAH
(beat)
Because when my husband was twenty-four, a man held a knife to his throat in that same store over the register. (beat) 1975. (beat) The man was hungry. (beat) Abdul-Rahman gave him the money and a sandwich and said, "Come back tomorrow, and I'll give you a job." (beat) The man came back. (beat) He swept that floor for nine years. (beat) He was at our son's wedding. (beat) I want the boy who killed my husband to see the face of the woman who has to bury him. (beat) That's all. (beat) What he does with it is between him and God.

Yusuf, behind her, has started to cry silently.

NATASHA
(beat, slowly)
I'll speak to the police. (beat) And to his doctors. (beat) I can't promise you.

KHADIJAH
(beat, rising)
I didn't ask for a promise, Dr. Donohue. (beat) I asked for a door.

21 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - ORTHOPEDICS - CAST ROOM - DAY

MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 12:52 PM

Harmony splints a teenager's wrist. Camille (29) reads films, humming. On the counter, half a King cake from Fulton Street, the second one. Camille bought it Saturday.

HARMONY
(beat)
He shook my hand. (beat) Your father. (beat) Last night. (beat) At the door. (beat) Before I even got my coat off.

CAMILLE
(beat, not looking up from the films)
He shook your hand.

HARMONY
(beat)
And he said, "Welcome, Harmony." (beat) Not "Mademoiselle Divine." (beat) Not "Dr. Divine." (beat) "Harmony."

Camille turns from the light box. Her eyes are bright.

CAMILLE
(beat)
He made red beans and rice. (beat) On a Sunday. (beat) He only makes red beans on Mondays. (beat) It's a New Orleans rule. (beat) He broke a rule for you.

HARMONY
(beat)
And he asked us both to come back tomorrow. (beat) Mardi Gras. (beat) He said, "In New Orleans, Mardi Gras is the day you say what you are, because tomorrow you'll have to give it up for Lent."

Camille sets down the film she's holding.

CAMILLE
(beat, barely)
He's going to say it, Choir. (beat) Tomorrow. (beat) I know my father. (beat) He's going to say it out loud.

22 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CARDIOTHORACIC OFFICE - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 1:14 PM

Robert's office. A folded blanket and a pillow on his sofa too. Robert sits at his desk reviewing Dash's cultures. Amond comes in with a printout.

AMOND
(beat)
Staph aureus. (beat) Methicillin-sensitive. (beat) Blood cultures negative so far. (beat) Ultrasound shows no fluid around the pump pocket. (beat) Just the driveline.

ROBERT
(beat)
Good. (beat) Six weeks of antibiotics. (beat) Daily dressing changes. (beat) He'll stay in until a heart comes.

Amond looks at the blanket on the sofa.

AMOND
(beat)
Sir. (beat) With respect. (beat) You've slept here eleven nights this month. (beat) The night security guard told Big Ray, and Big Ray told Monty, and Monty told me.

ROBERT
(beat, not looking up)
Monty is a vault, Dr. Baker.

AMOND
(beat)
Monty is a vault with a tap, sir. (beat) His words.

Robert sets down his pen. He looks tired. Older than fifty.

ROBERT
(beat, quietly)
My wife and I are seeing a therapist tonight. (beat) In Brooklyn Heights. (beat) For the first time in twenty-eight years of marriage. (beat) I have performed two thousand open-heart operations, Amond, and I'm terrified of a woman with a box of tissues.

AMOND
(beat)
Dr. Greenidge?

ROBERT
(beat, staring at him)
How do you know that?

AMOND
(beat, dry)
Everybody in this building who's married sees Dr. Greenidge, sir. (beat) It's practically a department.

23 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - NEURO STEP-DOWN - ROOM 3 - DAY

MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 1:41 PM

Russell, in his padded helmet, sits in a chair by the window doing hand exercises with a squeeze ball, his left hand stronger now. Elxa sits on the bed with Tuck. Graves stands at the door with a schedule.

GRAVES
(beat)
March twentieth. (beat) A cranioplasty. (beat) We put your bone flap back. (beat) Then you can retire the helmet, Mr. Jeffries.

RUSSELL
(beat, slowly)
And go back to teaching?

GRAVES
(beat)
After Easter. (beat) Half days at first.

RUSSELL
(beat)
My step team has a competition in April. (beat) At Medgar Evers. (beat) I promised them.

GRAVES
(beat, dry)
Then I suppose I'd better put your head back together properly.

Graves leaves. Elxa looks at her husband in his helmet, squeezing the ball with his left hand, and laughs.

ELXA
(beat)
I drained Clayton Hartwell's butt this morning.

RUSSELL
(beat, staring at her)
You what?

ELXA
(beat)
Perianal abscess. (beat) Procedure Room Two. (beat) Tuck was there. (beat) He cried. (beat) Clayton cried louder.

Russell laughs so hard he has to hold his helmet.

24 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL ICU - FAMILY ROOM - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 2:06 PM

A small, plain room. A heavyset woman in her forties in a home-care aide's uniform sits alone, her face in her hands: DOROTHEA RHAMES (44), Quinton's mother. Arianna comes in with a cup of water and sits down across from her.

DOROTHEA
(beat, not looking up)
They won't let me see him. (beat) There's a police officer at the door.

ARIANNA
(beat)
He's stable, Mrs. Rhames. (beat) His liver's packed. (beat) He'll go back to surgery Wednesday. (beat) He's going to live.

DOROTHEA
(beat, barely)
And go to prison.

ARIANNA
(beat)
Probably. (beat) Yes, ma'am.

Dorothea finally looks up.

DOROTHEA
(beat)
I raised him by myself in the Lefrak City towers. (beat) I worked doubles. (beat) He was a good boy until he was fourteen. (beat) Then he met the wrong people, and I couldn't stop it. (beat) I tried. (beat) I tried everything.

ARIANNA
(beat, quietly)
I know you did.

DOROTHEA
(beat)
How would you know?

ARIANNA
(beat)
Because my father went to prison when I was seventeen. (beat) And my mother was too sick to try. (beat) And I used to wish every single night that somebody had tried as hard for him as you tried for your son.

Dorothea stares at the young doctor.

ARIANNA
(beat)
It wasn't you, Mrs. Rhames. (beat) Whatever he did on Roosevelt Avenue this morning, it wasn't you.

25 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL ICU - BED 2 - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 2:31 PM

Quinton, sedation lightened, awake and frightened, the tube still in. The officer stands by the door. Natasha stands beside the officer. Lowery and Marc stand at the foot of the bed. Kennerly holds the door. And through it, slowly, in her black abaya and gray hijab, comes Sister Khadijah Bey.

She walks to the side of the bed. She stands there. She looks down at the young man who killed her husband six hours ago. Quinton looks up and sees her. He doesn't know who she is. Then he does. His eyes fill with terror.

KHADIJAH
(beat, very quietly)
My name is Khadijah Bey. (beat) Abdul-Rahman Bey was my husband for thirty-four years.

END OF ACT THREE

ACT FOUR

26 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL ICU - BED 2 - DAY

MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 2:32 PM

Khadijah stands beside the bed. Quinton stares up at her, tears running sideways into the tape around the breathing tube. Nobody else in the room moves.

KHADIJAH
(beat, steady)
My husband opened that store in 1972. (beat) He was twenty-four. (beat) Your age. (beat) In 1975, a man held a knife to his throat over that same register. (beat) My husband gave him the money. (beat) Then he gave him a sandwich. (beat) Then he said, "Come back tomorrow, and I'll give you a job."

Quinton closes his eyes. Khadijah waits until he opens them again.

KHADIJAH
(beat)
Look at me, young man. (beat) I'm not here to forgive you. (beat) I don't have that in me today. (beat) Maybe God will give it to me someday. (beat) Maybe not. (beat) I'm here so that for the rest of your life, when you think about this morning, you will see my face. (beat) Not a store. (beat) Not a register. (beat) Not a hundred and eighty dollars. (beat) A woman who has to go home tonight to a bed with one pillow in it.

Quinton makes a sound around the tube, a broken, choking sound. His hand moves on the sheet toward the clipboard.

Khadijah shakes her head.

KHADIJAH
(beat)
Don't write anything. (beat)
You'll have years to write.
(beat) My husband would have
handed you a broom, young man.
(beat) That's who you killed.
(beat) A man who would have
handed you a broom.

She turns and walks out. Her son is waiting in the doorway. She takes his arm. Natasha stands aside to let them pass. Marc, at the foot of the bed, watches Quinton cry.

27 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL ICU - CORRIDOR - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 2:41 PM

Khadijah has gone ahead to the elevator with the detective. Yusuf stands against the wall in his Con Ed jacket, shaking. Kennerly stands beside him.

YUSUF
(beat, barely)
She didn't scream at him. (beat)
She didn't hit him. (beat) I
wanted her to. (beat) I wanted
to.

KENNERLY
(beat)
I know.

YUSUF
(beat)
How do you know?

KENNERLY
(beat, honestly)
Because in September I told a whole cafeteria a secret that wasn't mine, to hurt somebody I was jealous of. (beat) And the person I hurt never hit me either. (beat) He just kept being better than me until I couldn't stand myself. (beat) That's worse than getting hit, Mr. Bey. (beat) Your mother just did that to him.

Yusuf looks at the young doctor for a long moment.

YUSUF
(beat)
My father would have liked you. (beat) He liked people who said the hard thing.

KENNERLY
(beat)
I'm working on the "liked" part.

28 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL ICU - SCRUB SINK - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 2:51 PM

A steel sink outside the unit. Marc washes his hands. Washes them again. Lowery comes up beside him and turns on the other faucet.

LOWERY
(beat, scrubbing)
You've washed your hands four times since that woman walked out.

MARC
(beat)
I know.

LOWERY
(beat)
They're clean, Dr. Bullock.

MARC
(beat, still scrubbing)
I held his liver this morning, Dr. Lowery. (beat) I'd do it again. (beat) I'd do it every time. (beat) And she looked at him like he was the worst thing that ever happened to her. (beat) And he is. (beat) Both are true. (beat) I don't know where to put both.

Lowery turns off his faucet. He reaches over and turns off Marc's too.

LOWERY
(beat)
You don't put them anywhere, son. (beat) You carry them. (beat) That's what the white coat is for. (beat) Pockets.

29 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - DR. BYNUM'S OFFICE - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 4:01 PM

The small office, the soft lamps. Dr. Bynum (63) in his bow tie. Marc on the sofa. Session three. He's less guarded than two weeks ago.

DR. BYNUM
(beat)
How many times did you flinch this week?

MARC
(beat)
Amond says six. (beat) I say four. (beat) He counts the small ones.

DR. BYNUM
(beat)
And today?

MARC
(beat)
A police officer said "Thank you, Doctor." (beat) That's all. (beat) Three words. (beat) I was on the loading dock again. (beat) The flag. (beat) The patch on top of it.

DR. BYNUM
(beat)
Tell me about the officer.

MARC
(beat)
He was guarding a man I operated on. (beat) A man who killed a store owner this morning. (beat) A man who wrote "I didn't mean to" on a clipboard. (beat) And I thought, Sergeant Burrell died so people could go home. (beat) And this man killed somebody so he could have a hundred and eighty dollars. (beat) And I saved him. (beat) And some part of me was asking whether he deserved it.

DR. BYNUM
(beat, gently)
Did he?

Marc is quiet for a long time.

MARC
(beat)
It's not my question. (beat) That's what Lowery said. (beat) "We operate on what's bleeding." (beat) I believe that. (beat) I just didn't know that believing it would feel like this.

DR. BYNUM
(beat)
How does it feel?

MARC
(beat)
Like holding the shell. (beat) Perfectly still on the outside. (beat) And inside, everything white.

DR. BYNUM
(beat, writing nothing)
Is there anything in your life right now that isn't white, Dr. Bullock?

Marc thinks about it.

MARC
(beat)
A vet in Astoria opened her door at six-thirty this morning in her pajamas. (beat) She held my dog's head while it threw up chocolate. (beat) She told me to go to work. (beat) She said, "That's the whole job." (beat) That wasn't white.

DR. BYNUM
(beat, a small smile)
Then perhaps you should go pick up your dog.

30 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CHIEF'S OFFICE - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 4:31 PM

Natasha sits on her office sofa, next to the folded blanket, holding Tuck in the crook of her arm. Elxa stands at the window, buttoning her coat.

ELXA
(beat)
You're going to Brooklyn Heights tonight. (beat) With Daddy.

NATASHA
(beat, not looking up from the baby)
Bernie talks too much.

ELXA
(beat)
Bernie told me nothing, Mama. (beat) There's a blanket on your sofa and a blanket on Daddy's. (beat) I'm a surgeon. (beat) I notice things.

Natasha strokes the baby's cheek with one finger.

NATASHA
(beat, quietly)
Your father did something a long time ago. (beat) Before Grace was a year old. (beat) He told me. (beat) Finally. (beat) We're going to try to talk about it in front of somebody who's paid to listen.

ELXA
(beat, turning)
Are you going to be okay?

NATASHA
(beat)
I'm going to be sober, baby. (beat) Everything else, I'll find out.

Tuck opens his eyes and stares up at his grandmother.

NATASHA
(beat, softly, to the baby)
Your granddaddy is a good man who did a bad thing, Tuck. (beat) That's most people. (beat) Don't let anybody tell you it's simpler than that.

31 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - ELEVATOR - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 4:48 PM

The doors open on seven. Malcolm, his nose healing, the bruises faded to yellow, is inside. Esther gets on. She doesn't look at him. The doors close.

MALCOLM
(beat, eyes on the numbers)
The vet.

ESTHER
(beat)
What?

MALCOLM
(beat)
In the SICU corridor this morning. (beat) Your face when he said "Faith." (beat) I've known your face since you were six, Est. (beat) That was the face you made when your sister Kat got the bigger bike.

ESTHER
(beat, sharply)
You don't get to read my face anymore, Malcolm.

MALCOLM
(beat)
I know. (beat) I'm sorry. (beat) It's a bad habit.

Six. Five. Four.

ESTHER
(beat, still not looking at him)
Clayton said you asked him to lunch.

MALCOLM
(beat)
I did.

ESTHER
(beat)
Why?

MALCOLM
(beat)
Because I owe him the same thing I owe you. (beat) To stand in front of him and let him look at me. (beat) In the daylight. (beat) Over a burger. (beat) Without anybody hitting anybody.

Three. Two. One. The doors open on the lobby.

ESTHER
(beat, stepping out)
Monty's has good burgers. (beat) Tell Clayton I said to go.

32 INT. ASTORIA ANIMAL HOSPITAL - EXAM ROOM - DUSK
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 5:14 PM

Mercy, much better, on the steel table, wagging her whole body as Marc comes through the door. Faith Danforth, in a lab coat over a sweater now, her hair still in a knot, unhooks the IV and presses a cotton ball to the dog's leg.

FAITH
(beat)
Heart rate ninety-six. (beat) She ate a bowl of rice and boiled chicken at three. (beat) She stole a second bowl from the Pomeranian in the next kennel at three-fifteen. (beat) She's fine.

Mercy launches herself off the table into Marc's arms, tail going like a propeller. He catches her and holds her against his chest. Faith watches them, smiling.

MARC
(beat)
What do I owe you?

FAITH
(beat)
Two hundred and twelve dollars. (beat) And one honest answer.

MARC
(beat)
To what?

FAITH
(beat, leaning against the counter)
You looked at that dog this morning like she was the only thing in the world that hadn't let you down lately. (beat) I've been a vet for nine years, Dr. Bullock. (beat) I know that look. (beat) It's the look people get when the dog is the safest relationship they have.

Marc doesn't answer. Mercy licks his chin.

FAITH
(beat)
So here's my question. (beat) Would you like to have dinner with me on Saturday? (beat) Nothing complicated. (beat) There's a Greek place on Ditmars with octopus that I'm told is terrible cold.

MARC
(beat, startled into a laugh)
I've heard about the octopus.

FAITH
(beat)
Then you know the stakes.

Marc looks at her. Kind. Calm. Uncomplicated. Standing in a worn exam room under the N train with a stethoscope around her neck and dog hair on her sleeve.

MARC
(beat, carefully)
Dr. Danforth. (beat) I should tell you, I'm... (beat) My life is very complicated right now.

FAITH
(beat, unbothered)
Dogs are complicated, Dr. Bullock. (beat) Horses are complicated. (beat) I'm not. (beat) That's my best quality.

A long beat. Mercy wiggles in his arms.

MARC
(beat)
Saturday.

END OF ACT FOUR

ACT FIVE

33 INT. DR. PAULETTE GREENIDGE'S OFFICE - BROOKLYN HEIGHTS - NIGHT
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 6:32 PM

The brownstone office on Montague Street: the kente throw, the box of tissues, the clock only the therapist can see. Dr. Paulette Greenidge (50) sits in her chair. On the sofa, at opposite ends, as far apart as two people can sit on one sofa: Natasha and Robert.

DR. GREENIDGE
(gently)
Dr. Donohue. (beat) Dr. Bullock. (beat) I'll say this once, and then I won't say it again. (beat) I know who you are. (beat) I've seen your names in the newspaper. (beat) In this room, you are Natasha and Robert. (beat) That's all. (beat) Is that acceptable?

NATASHA
(beat)
Yes.

ROBERT
(beat)
Yes.

DR. GREENIDGE
(beat)
Then let's begin with an easy question. (beat) Why now?

A long silence. Robert looks at his hands. Natasha looks out the window at Montague Street.

NATASHA
(beat, finally)
Three weeks ago, our son held a live bomb inside a man for four hours. (beat) A police sergeant died carrying it out. (beat) I stood at a window and watched my son not move. (beat) And that night, in a parking garage, my husband told me he had something to tell me about 1981. (beat) He said he'd made a promise through that window. (beat) If our son walked out alive, he'd stop carrying things.

DR. GREENIDGE
(beat)
And he told you.

NATASHA
(beat)
He told me. (beat) Eight days later. (beat) An affair. (beat) Two months. (beat) When our youngest was six months old.

DR. GREENIDGE
(beat, to Robert)
Robert. (beat) Why did you keep it for twenty-four years?

ROBERT
(beat, his voice very quiet)
Because by the time I'd found the courage, she was drinking. (beat) 1985. 1986. (beat) And by the time she was sober, I'd decided the truth would put a bottle back in her hand. (beat) So I told myself I was protecting her. (beat) For sixteen years. (beat) I was protecting myself.

Natasha turns from the window and looks at him.

DR. GREENIDGE
(beat)
Natasha. (beat) What do you want from these sessions?

NATASHA
(beat, honestly)
I don't know yet. (beat) I want to stop sleeping on my office sofa. (beat) I want to not want a drink when he comes into a room. (beat) And I want to find out if a marriage can survive both of us having been the person who needed forgiving.

DR. GREENIDGE
(beat, a small nod)
That's a very good place to begin. (beat) Same time next week?

ROBERT
(beat)
Same time next week.

NATASHA
(beat, standing, picking up her coat)
Not Thursdays, Dr. Greenidge. (beat) I'm told Thursdays are taken.

DR. GREENIDGE
(beat, without missing a beat)
I couldn't possibly comment, Natasha.

34 INT. CLAYTON'S SUBLET - BROOKLYN HEIGHTS - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 7:31 PM

Clayton stands at the window. He is not sitting. Esther comes in, drops her bag and looks at him.

ESTHER
(beat)
Why are you standing?

CLAYTON
(beat)
No more Octobers.

ESTHER
(beat, wary)
Okay.

CLAYTON
(beat, with great dignity)
I had a perianal abscess. (beat) Elxa Bullock drained it this morning in Procedure Room Two with her three-week-old son watching. (beat) I'm to have sitz baths twice a day. (beat) I can't sit until Thursday.

Esther stares at him. Then she bursts out laughing. She laughs so hard she has to sit on the arm of the sofa. Clayton watches her with long-suffering dignity.

CLAYTON
(beat)
And Malcolm asked me to lunch.

Esther stops laughing.

ESTHER
(beat)
I know. (beat) He told me in the elevator. (beat) I told him Monty's has good burgers. (beat) I told him to tell you I said go.

CLAYTON
(beat)
You did?

ESTHER
(beat)
I did. (beat) And no more Octobers. (beat) My turn. (beat) This morning, Marc said the vet's name. (beat) Faith. (beat) And I was jealous. (beat) Of a woman I've never met who opened her door in pajamas for a dog. (beat) I don't have the right to be jealous, Clayton. (beat) I chose you. (beat) I'm choosing you every day. (beat) But I was jealous anyway. (beat) That's the truth.

Clayton turns from the window. He looks at his wife for a long time.

CLAYTON
(beat, quietly)
Thank you for telling me.

ESTHER
(beat)
It doesn't make you angry?

CLAYTON
(beat)
It makes me sad. (beat) And grateful. (beat) And I'd sit down next to you if I could sit down.

35 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CVICU - BED 3 - NIGHT
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 8:09 PM

Dash's fever is down to one hundred point four. Raven sits beside him with his evening meds and a sleeve of crackers. The glass door slides open. Arianna stands there in her coat, a takeout bag in her hand. Raven freezes. Dash looks up.

ARIANNA
(beat, flat)
I brought Ellison dinner. (beat) She forgets to eat when she's here.

A long beat. Dash looks Arianna up and down. Arianna does the same to him.

DASH
(beat, slowly)
You're Problem.

ARIANNA
(beat)
You're the cantaloupe.

Raven closes her eyes. Dash grins, the gap-toothed grin, and holds out his hand. Arianna looks at it. Then she steps forward and shakes it.

DASH
(beat)
She talks about you. (beat) A lot. (beat) The purple cards. (beat) The kidney keychain. (beat) Twenty-four over.

ARIANNA
(beat)
She talks about you too. (beat) The decaf. (beat) The crackers. (beat) The Panthers blanket on the left side.

DASH
(beat)
So we're both in trouble.

ARIANNA
(beat, setting the bag on the tray table)
No. (beat) We're both in love with the same woman. (beat) That's different from trouble. (beat) Trouble is when you lie about it. (beat) Nobody in this room is lying.

Dash looks at her with genuine respect.

DASH
(beat)
You want a cracker, Problem?

ARIANNA
(beat, taking one)
I want you to get a heart, Duvall. (beat) So this is a fair fight.

36 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - NIGHT
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 8:47 PM

The kitchen. Mercy, completely recovered, trots in circles around the table with a new chew toy shaped like a chocolate bar, a joke gift from Faith. Harmony and Camille at the table with the last of the King cake. Amond reads. Marc comes in with takeout.

HARMONY
(beat)
Tomorrow's Mardi Gras. (beat) Augustin's. (beat) Halsey Street. (beat) Seven o'clock. (beat) He said, "Mardi Gras is the day you say what you are."

CAMILLE
(beat, to Marc)
My father is going to say something tomorrow that he's been not saying for twelve years. (beat) I can feel it. (beat) I need a drink.

Marc sets down the takeout. He leans against the counter.

MARC
(beat, casually)
I have a date Saturday.

Silence. Harmony's fork stops halfway to her mouth. Camille's head snaps around. Amond slowly lowers his journal.

HARMONY
(beat)
The vet.

MARC
(beat)
The vet.

HARMONY
(shrieking)
The vet with the Vespa!

CAMILLE
(beat, delighted)
Is she cute? (beat) She's cute. (beat) Look at his face, Choir. (beat) She's cute.

AMOND
(beat, raising the journal again, dry)
Where?

MARC
(beat)
Taverna Kyclades. (beat) On Ditmars.

AMOND
(beat, not looking up)
The octopus place. (beat) Bold choice. (beat) That place has a history.

37 EXT. BEY'S GROCERY - ROOSEVELT AVENUE, CORONA - NIGHT
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 9:34 PM

A small corner bodega under the elevated 7 train. Yellow police tape hangs torn and loose from the door. The steel shutter is half down. A sign in the window, in careful hand lettering: "BEY'S GROCERY -- SINCE 1972 -- CREDIT FOR MOTHERS." A 7 train thunders overhead.

Khadijah Bey, in her abaya, and Yusuf stand on the sidewalk. Yusuf unlocks the shutter and raises it with a long, rattling clatter. Inside, the register. A broom leaning against the counter.

Khadijah walks inside. She picks up the broom. She begins to sweep the floor, slowly, in the place where her husband died this morning. Yusuf stands in the doorway and watches his mother sweep.

YUSUF
(barely)
Mama. (beat) You don't have to do this tonight.

KHADIJAH
(still sweeping, not looking up)
Your father swept this floor every night for thirty-four years, Yusuf. (beat) Tonight, somebody sweeps it. (beat) Tomorrow, we open at six. (beat) The mothers on this block need milk.

38 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL ICU - BED 2 - NIGHT
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 10:02 PM

Quinton, awake, the tube still in. The officer stands by the door. Dorothea Rhames, in her aide's uniform, sits on the edge of the bed holding her son's hand with both of hers. Arianna stands by the door. She arranged this. Natasha signed it.

DOROTHEA
(whispering)
I'm here, baby. (beat) I'm here. (beat) I don't know what you did. (beat) The police told me. (beat) I don't understand it. (beat) But I'm your mother. (beat) I'm here.

Quinton cries around the tube. Dorothea holds his hand against her cheek.

DOROTHEA
(beat)
The woman who came to see you today. (beat) The detective told me. (beat) The wife. (beat) She came and stood right where I'm standing. (beat) Do you understand what that cost her, Quinton? (beat) Do you understand what kind of woman that is?

Quinton nods. Slowly. Arianna, at the door, turns and walks out quietly to give them the room.

39 INT. NATASHA AND ROBERT'S BROWNSTONE - RIVERSIDE DRIVE - BEDROOM - NIGHT
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 10:47 PM

The master bedroom. Natasha stands in her robe by the bed. Robert stands in the doorway in pajamas with his pillow under his arm, out of habit, on his way to the guest room.

NATASHA
(beat)
Robert.

ROBERT
(beat)
Good night, Tasha.

NATASHA
(beat)
You can sleep in here. (beat) On your side. (beat) Not touching. (beat) Not talking. (beat) Just in the same room.

Robert stands in the doorway for a long time.

ROBERT
(beat, barely)
Are you sure?

NATASHA
(beat, getting into bed, turning out her lamp)
No. (beat) Dr. Greenidge says I don't have to be sure. (beat) I just have to be honest. (beat) Honestly, I don't want to be in this bed alone tonight. (beat) That's all.

Robert walks to his side of the bed. He lies down on top of the covers, on the very edge, with his pillow. In the dark, neither of them moves.

TAG

40 EXT. PULASKI BRIDGE - NIGHT
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 11:31 PM

The Pulaski Bridge at night, empty, the Manhattan skyline glittering to the west. A single red Vespa buzzes across it from Greenpoint into Long Island City, its headlight cutting through the cold. Faith Danforth, in a helmet and a peacoat, a pet carrier strapped to the back with a rescued kitten inside, rides home from a late call.

MARC (V.O.)
They teach you that every patient deserves the same care.

41 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - MARC'S ROOM - NIGHT
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 27, 2006 - 11:58 PM

Marc in bed in the dark. Mercy, fully recovered, sprawls across his legs with her chew toy. Through the window, a red light crosses the Pulaski Bridge far in the distance and disappears into Queens.

MARC (V.O.)
A man who held a broom. A man who held a gun. A woman who came to look him in the eye. (beat) A mother who held his hand anyway.

Marc rests his hand on the dog's head.

MARC (V.O.)
We don't get to decide who deserves to be saved. (beat) That's the hardest thing about this job. (beat) And the second hardest thing is believing that, maybe, we deserve something good too.

Mercy sighs.

MARC (V.O.)
Even if it's just dinner. (beat) Even if it's just Saturday.

FADE OUT.

END OF EPISODE

Media Companion: Episode 2x19

Off-screen media around the episode, in chronological order. Not counted in page length (MA-009 §5).

NEW YORK DAILY NEWS: "CORONA GROCER SLAIN IN HOLDUP; SUSPECT SHOT BY COPS"

Monday, February 27, 2006 (afternoon edition)

"Abdul-Rahman Bey, 57, who had run Bey's Grocery on Roosevelt Avenue since 1972 and was known on the block for extending credit to struggling mothers, was shot dead this morning during a robbery. Police shot the 24-year-old suspect as he fled. He is in critical condition at Queens Grace Hospital." (A fictional event.)

ASSOCIATED PRESS: "SHANI DAVIS MAKES OLYMPIC HISTORY" / "OCTAVIA BUTLER, SCI-FI PIONEER, DIES AT 58"

February 2006

"TURIN, Italy (AP) -- Shani Davis of Chicago won the 1,000 meters on Feb. 18, becoming the first Black athlete to win an individual gold medal at the Winter Olympics..." / "SEATTLE (AP) -- Octavia E. Butler, the award-winning science fiction author of 'Kindred' and 'Parable of the Sower,' died Feb. 24 at 58." (The Turin Games closed February 26.)

QueensGraceConfidential (Blogger)

Monday, February 27, 2006, 7:44 PM

"A WIDOW IN THE SICU. We'll keep this short and respectful. A woman whose husband was killed this morning on Roosevelt Avenue walked into the room of the man accused of killing him, said her piece, and walked out. That's all. We can't stop thinking about it. Lighter notes: a certain Chief of OB was spotted walking VERY carefully today and refusing to sit. A certain intern from the 49th Avenue house has a DATE on Saturday with a VET who rides a VESPA. And a certain transplant patient on his second LVAD admission met a certain girlfriend and they shook hands. Stay tuned." Comments (3,377).

Card with a Valentine's box (chewed): Dash Duvall to Raven Ellison

Delivered February 24, 2006

"To my Valentine. Sorry it's late. They don't let you buy candy in the CVICU. -D."

Note left in Clayton Hartwell's mailbox

Sunday, February 26, 2006

"Lunch. Monty's. Any day. You pick. -M."

Window sign, Bey's Grocery, Roosevelt Avenue

Hand-lettered, about 1990

"BEY'S GROCERY -- SINCE 1972 -- CREDIT FOR MOTHERS"

Continuity Sheet: Episode 2x19

New Canon Established

- **DR. FAITH DANFORTH'S DEBUT** (33; counterpart of Finn Dandridge): Astoria Animal Hospital on 31st Street under the N train (est. 1962). She lives upstairs, rides a red Vespa over the Pulaski Bridge, and has a UConn veterinary background. **Mercy ate twelve Godiva dark-chocolate truffles** (Dash's late Valentine to Raven) at about 5:50 AM. Faith opened at 6:31 AM in pajamas and treated theobromine toxicity with apomorphine, activated charcoal, IV fluids and cardiac monitoring (HR 190, down to 96). She recognized Marc from the news and said nothing: 'I read the vet journals and the comics.' **She asked Marc to dinner Saturday, March 4, at Taverna Kyclades on Ditmars** ('Dogs are complicated. I'm not'), and he said yes. She sent Mercy home with a chocolate-bar chew toy. The bill was $212.
- **Esther is jealous of Faith** (Amond: 'That was jealousy, Marc'). Malcolm read it on her face ('the face you made when your sister Kat got the bigger bike'). **Esther told Clayton** under No More Octobers: 'I was jealous anyway. That's the truth.' Clayton: 'It makes me sad. And grateful.' **Malcolm asked Clayton to lunch** by note ('Monty's. Any day. You pick'), and Esther told Malcolm to tell Clayton to go.
- **CLAYTON'S EMBARRASSING AILMENT** (counterpart of Addison asking Bailey): a golf-ball-sized perianal abscess for five days (he did a twin-twin laser standing on one leg). **Elxa, on maternity leave, drained it** in locked Procedure Room 2 with Tuck in the room: 'I'll drain your butt. But I'm bringing the baby.' Sitz baths, packing, and no sitting until Thursday. He told Esther, and she laughed until she had to sit down.
- **DASH READMITTED** (counterpart of Denny's readmission): the HeartMate went in February 14 (Raven second-assisted, Arianna watched from the gallery). He was discharged February 24 to Glenda's sublet on 21st Street, Astoria, walked to Steinway Street, and called it the best three days of his life. He was readmitted February 27 with an **MSSA driveline exit-site infection** (fever 102.8, pump pocket clear on ultrasound), on vancomycin/cefepime then six weeks of antibiotics, inpatient until a heart comes, still Status 1A. Raven: 'We're not over' (about Arianna). **Arianna and Dash met:** 'You're Problem.' 'You're the cantaloupe.' 'We're both in love with the same woman... Nobody in this room is lying.' 'I want you to get a heart, Duvall. So this is a fair fight.'
- **THE COUNSELING ARC:** Natasha and Robert's first session with **Dr. Paulette Greenidge** (Mondays, 'not Thursdays'). Robert: he kept the affair secret because Natasha was drinking (1985-86), then because of her sobriety, 'protecting myself.' Natasha: 'find out if a marriage can survive both of us having been the person who needed forgiving.' **Robert slept in their bedroom again**, on his side, on top of the covers. Both had been sleeping on office sofas some nights; Robert had 11 office nights in February (per Big Ray, Monty and Amond). Natasha told Elxa that her father 'did something a long time ago... before Grace was a year old,' but not what. **Marc's session 3 with Dr. Bynum:** 'Like holding the shell. Perfectly still on the outside. And inside, everything white.' Faith 'wasn't white.'
- **The Bey case:** Quinton Rhames (24, of the Lefrak City towers) shot and killed grocer **Abdul-Rahman Bey** (57) at 7:10 AM on Roosevelt Avenue for $180 and two cartons of Newports, and was shot by police. Lowery and Marc did a Pringle maneuver and

damage-control liver packing (relook Wednesday). He wrote 'IS HE DEAD' and 'I DIDNT MEAN TO. GUN WENT OFF.' **Marc gave the clipboard to the officer. Sister Khadijah Bey** came to his bedside: 'I'm not here to forgive you... My husband would have handed you a broom.' That night she swept the store floor, and it opens at 6 AM. Arianna sat with Quinton's mother Dorothea, and Natasha approved her visit.

- **Arianna's past (new canon):** her father Raymond Cummings shot a man over $40 of heroin in 1996 (the man lived) and did six years at Western Penitentiary, Pittsburgh. The victim's daughter was in her class at Schenley High School. **Kennerly asked Kendra to dinner Friday** ('Tablecloths. You're paying'). **Harmony and Camille at Augustin's on Sunday, February 26:** he shook Harmony's hand: 'Welcome, Harmony.' He made red beans and rice on a Sunday, breaking the Monday rule. **Mardi Gras dinner at Halsey Street is February 28:** 'Mardi Gras is the day you say what you are.' Camille bought the second King cake. Russell's cranioplasty is set for March 20, then teaching after Easter; his step team competes at Medgar Evers in April.

Knowledge Tracker (as of February 27, 2006)

Item	Who knows
Marc's Saturday date with Faith	The housemates, Camille, Esther (by inference), the blog
Clayton's abscess	Elxa, Clayton, Esther (and the blog, vaguely)
Natasha and Robert in counseling	Bernie, Amond, Elxa (partial), Dr. Greenidge
Robert's affair (content)	Robert, Natasha, Dr. Greenidge; Amond (inferred); Elxa knows only 'something'
Mariah Pettaway; the sealed letter	No one / unopened

Patient Registry

Patient	DOB / age	Diagnosis	Procedure / surgeon	Outcome
Quinton Rhames	6/30/1981 (24)	Two GSWs to the right upper quadrant; grade IV liver injury, retrohepatic bleeding	Pringle; damage-control packing; temporary closure (Lowery; Bullock; Cummings)	SICU under police guard; relook Wednesday
Darius 'Dash' Duvall	8/8/1971 (34)	LVAD driveline infection (MSSA)	Vancomycin/cefepime, then 6 weeks (R. Bullock; Baker; Ellison)	Fever 100.4; inpatient until transplant
Dr. Clayton Hartwell	3/3/1971 (34)	Perianal abscess	Incision and drainage under local (E. Bullock)	Sitz baths; no sitting until Thursday
Mercy (canine)	about 9/2005	Theobromine toxicity (12 dark truffles)	Apomorphine, activated charcoal, IV fluids (Danforth)	Recovered

New Characters

- **Dr. Faith Danforth**, debut (in MA-005). **Quinton Rhames** (b. June 30, 1981) and **Dorothea Rhames** (b. August 8, 1961). **Sister Khadijah Bey** (b. September 1, 1947) and **Yusuf Bey** (b. December 20, 1975); **Abdul-Rahman Bey** (1948-2006), mentioned.

Real-World Accuracy Notes

- Shani Davis won the 1,000 m speed skating gold at the Turin Winter Olympics on February 18, 2006, the first Black athlete to win an individual Winter Olympic gold, and the Games closed February 26. Octavia E. Butler died February 24, 2006. February 27, 2006 was Lundi Gras and February 28 was Mardi Gras. Red beans and rice is traditionally a Monday dish in New Orleans.
- Medicine: theobromine toxicity in dogs is dose-dependent and worst with dark chocolate. It is treated with induced emesis (apomorphine) within a few hours, activated charcoal, fluids and cardiac monitoring. Driveline infection is the most common complication of a pulsatile LVAD, and device complications qualified candidates for Status 1A. Damage-control laparotomy (perihepatic packing, temporary closure, ICU resuscitation, relook in 24-72 hours) is standard for exsanguinating liver injury, and the Pringle maneuver occludes the portal triad. Perianal abscesses need incision and drainage, followed by sitz baths.